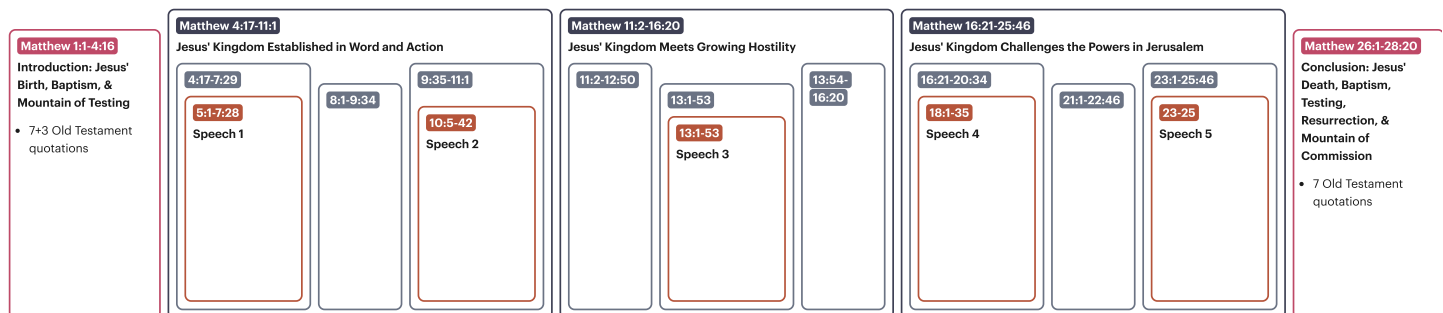


Session 2: Jesus Announces the Kingdom of Heaven

Key Takeaways

- Matthew organized his gospel around five teaching sections, beginning with the Sermon on the Mount.
- Matthew weaves Jesus' announcement that the kingdom of the skies has come together with his teachings and healings, emphasizing the interconnectedness of people's daily lived experience, community dynamics, and transcendent spiritual truths.
- Jesus calls people to "Change direction!" because "The kingdom of the skies is near!"—in other words, God's rule is breaking into earthly reality.
- Matthew focuses on how Jesus fulfills prophetic expectations for Abraham's descendants.

The Sermon on the Mount Within the Macro Design of Matthew



Matthew 1-28. Translation and Literary Design by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Rise of the Messiah (2024).

Matthew has carefully crafted his account with a matching introduction and conclusion.

- Matthew 1:1-4:16 introduces Jesus as the son of Abraham and David and the son of God: He is born as a human, baptized, and tested on a wilderness mountain, all marked by 7 + 3 quotations from Scripture (seven "fulfillment" quotes + three quotes).
- Matthew 26:1-28:20 brings Jesus' vocation as son of David and son of God to a climactic conclusion: He is tested in a garden, executed (his "baptism"), resurrected, and then commissions his disciples on a mountain, all marked by seven quotations from Scripture.

Between the introductory and concluding frames, Matthew 4:17-25:46 takes the story from Jesus' movement to Galilee to announce God's Kingdom (4:12-17) to Jesus' final days in Jerusalem (26:1-28:20). Matthew has organized this section in three large parts, the first and last of which have matching introductions that set the main theme for the unit.

Matthew 4:17 Instructor's Translation

From then on, Jesus began (ἀπὸ τότε ἤρξατο ὁ Ἰησοῦς)
to announce and say

“Change-direction!
Because the kingdom of the skies has come near!”

Matthew 16:21 Instructor's Translation

From then on, Iesous began (ἀπὸ τότε ἤρξατο ὁ Ἰησοῦς)
to point out that it was necessary for him to go to Ierosoluma,
and to suffer many things by the elders and chief-priests and scribes,
and to be killed,
and on the third day, to be raised up.

These introductions are coordinated with the conclusions to the five matching conclusions to the speeches.

Matthew 7:28 Instructor's Translation

And it came about when Iesous finished (ἐτέλεσεν) **these words ...**

Matthew 11:1 Instructor's Translation

And it came about when he finished (ἐτέλεσεν) **instructing his twelve apprentices ...**

Matthew 13:53 Instructor's Translation

And it came about when Iesous finished (ἐτέλεσεν) **these parables ...**

Matthew 19:1 Instructor's Translation

And it came about when Iesous finished (ἐτέλεσεν) **these words ...**

Matthew 26:1 Instructor's Translation

And it came about when Iesous finished (ἐτέλεσεν) **all these words ...**

The five teaching blocks are all arranged in a symmetrical way and with matching themes.

Matthew 5:1-7:29 Sermon on the Mount in Galilee • 7:28 "When Jesus finished these words ... "	Matthew 10:1-42 Sending Speech • 11:1 "When Jesus finished instructing the twelve ... "	Matthew 13:1-52 Kingdom Parables • 13:53 "When Jesus finished these parables ... "	Matthew 18:1-35 Kingdom Ethics • 19:1 "When Jesus finished these words ... "	Matthew 23:1-25:46 Speeches in Jerusalem • 26:1 "When Jesus finished all these words ... "
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Matthew 5-26. Translation and Literary Design by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Rise of the Messiah (2024).

The opening and closing teachings are the longest, and they display matching design and main themes, as summarized in the charts below.

Matthew 5:1-7:27		Sermon on the Mount	Matthew 23:1-25:46		Sermon about Jerusalem's Ruin
Matt. 5:1-16	Matt. 5:1-12	The nine blessings on the disciples	Matt. 23:1-38	Matt. 23:1-12	The seven woes on the Pharisees
	Matt. 5:13			Matt. 23:13-32	
	Matt. 5:14-16			Matt. 23:33-38	
Matt. 5:17-7:12	Matt. 5:17-48	Discourse on new covenant righteousness	Matt. 24:1-50	Matt. 24:1-14	Discourse on the ruin of Jerusalem and the exaltation of the Son of Man
	Matt. 6:1-18			Matt. 24:15-35	
	Matt. 6:19-7:12			Matt. 24:36-50	
Matt. 7:13-27	Matt. 7:13-14	Three parables about the two ways: • Wide and narrow gates • Wolves and sheep • Stable house and unstable house	Matt. 25:1-46	Matt. 25:1-13	Three parables about the culmination of the ages: • Wise and foolish women • Wise and rebel slaves • Sheep and goats
	Matt. 7:15-23			Matt. 25:14-30	
	Matt. 7:24-27			Matt. 25:31-46	
Matthew Sermon Comparison. Created by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Rise of the Messiah (2024).					

The three sections that make up the central body of Matthew advance the core themes and narrative claims that are made about Jesus.

- 4:17-11:1—Jesus is the Son of God, bringing the kingdom of the skies down to earth in word (chapters 5-7) and action (chapters 8-9), and then sends his disciples out to share in his mission (chapter 10).
- 11:2-16:20—Jesus' identity is developed and reacted to in different ways:
 - The disciples discern that Jesus is the Son of God
 - The crowds come to see Jesus as the son of David
 - The authorities view Jesus as a deceiver and threat to be destroyed

- 16:21-25:46—Jesus describes his identity as Son of God to suffer and die in Jerusalem for the sins of his people (chapters 16-20), and Jesus goes to the city (chapters 20-21) and engages the authorities (chapters 22-25).

The Sermon on the Mount Within Matthew 4-11

Matthew 4:17-7:29 4:17-5:2 - Jesus announces, "Kingdom of the skies is near!" - Teaching & announcing & healing - Calling the apostles 5:3-7:27 - Speech #1 - Sermon on the Mount - Kingdom of the skies 7:28-29 - Crowds Amazed by Authority	Matthew 8:1-9:34 8:1-17 - Three Healings - Lepre purified - Centurion's child - Peter's mother-in-law 8:18-9:8 - Three Wonders - Calming the storm - Two demonized men healed - Paralyzed man healed 9:9-34 - Three Healings - Two women healed - Two blind men healed - Mute man healed	Matthew 9:35-11:1 9:35-10:1 - Jesus announces the kingdom of the skies - Teaching & announcing & healing 10:2-4 - Jesus gives authority to 12 apostles - List of the 12 apostles 10:5-11:1 - Speech #2 - Commissioning the apostles to announce, "Kingdom of the skies is near!"
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Matthew 4:17-11:1. Translation and Literary Design by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: The Messianic Torah (2024).

Matthew 4:17-7:29

- **4:17-5:2** Jesus **heals, teaches, announces** "Kingdom of skies is near!" + **calling of apostles**
- **5:3-7:27** **Speech #1: Sermon on the Mount & Kingdom of the skies**
- **7:28-29** Crowds amazed by **authority**

Matthew 8:1-9:34

- **8:1-17** Three healings: Leper purified + Centurion's child healed + Peter's mother-in-law
- **8:18-9:8** Three wonders: Calming the storm + Two demonized men healed + Paralyzed man healed
- **9:9-34** Two women healed + Two blind men healed + Demonized mute man healed

Matthew 9:35-11:1

- **9:35-10:1** Jesus **heals, teaches, announces** "Kingdom of skies is near!"
- **10:2-4** Jesus gives **authority** to **12 apostles**
- **10:5-11:1** **Speech #2: Commissioning of apostles to announce "Kingdom of skies is near!"**

Matthew 4:17-11:1 - Vertical. Translation and Literary Design by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: The Messianic Torah (2024).

The Sermon on the Mount Within Matthew 4-7

Matthew 4:17-5:2

- **4:17** Jesus begins to announce “The kingdom of the skies has come near!”
- **4:18-22** Jesus calls 2 + 2 disciples
- **4:23-5:2** Jesus announces the Kingdom, teaching and healing disciples and crowds

Matthew 5:3-7:27

Sermon on the Mount

- **5:3-16** 3 + 3 + 3 “good life” sayings + 3 metaphors: salt, light, city
- **5:17-7:12** A righteousness that fulfills the Torah & Prophets
 - **5:17-48** 6 case studies in fulfilling the Torah
 - **6:1-21** 3 examples of real righteousness and true reward
 - **6:19-7:12** 6 examples of loving God & loving your neighbor
- **7:13-27** 3 warnings to respond: 2 gates & roads + 2 trees + 2 houses

Matthew 7:28-29

Crowd’s response: “Where did he get such authority?!”

Matthew 4:17-7:29. Translation and Literary Design by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: The Messianic Torah (2024).

Jesus Announces the Kingdom of Heaven

¹⁷ From then on, Jesus began to **announce** and say,
“Change-direction!
Because **the kingdom of** **the skies** has come near!”

A

¹⁸ Now, while walking **beside the sea** of **Galilaia**,
he saw **two brothers**,
Simon, who is called **Petros**,
and **Andreas** his brother,
throwing a fishing **net** into the sea,
because they were fishers,

B

¹⁹ **and he said to them**,
“Come after me,
and I will make you fishers of humans.”

C 20 And **immediately, leaving** the **nets**,
they followed him .

A' 21 And having moved on from there,
he saw **two other brothers**,
lakobos , **the one of Zebedaios**,
and ioannes his brother,
in the boat with Zebedaios their father,
they were repairing their **nets**,

B' **and he called to them** ,

C' 22 and **immediately, after leaving** the boat and their father,
they followed him .

23 And he traveled around in all of **Galilaia**,
teaching in their synagogues,
and **announcing the good news of the Kingdom**,
and **healing** every **sickness** ¹ and every **disease** ² among **the people** .

24 And the report about him went out into all of Syria,
and they brought to him
all who had **illness with any variety of sicknesses**,³
and those suffering **tormenting-pain**,⁴
and the **demonized**,⁵
and those suffering **lunacy**,⁶
and the **paralyzed**,⁷
and he **healed** them.

25 And **many crowds** **followed him** ,
from **Galilaia**,
and the Dekapolis,
and Ierosoluma,
and Ioudaia,
and beyond the Iordanes,
^{5:1} and, seeing **the crowds** , he went up onto **the mountain**,
and sitting down, his disciples came to him,
² and opening his mouth, **he taught them**, saying,

The “Kingdom of God” was the main theme in Jesus’ teaching. He claimed that in his actions, God’s Kingdom was actually becoming reality here on earth.

- [Mark 1:15](#)—“The Kingdom of God has arrived.”
- [Matthew 12:28](#)—“Hey everyone, God is now starting to run the show!”

In the Hebrew Bible, the “Kingdom” of God refers to God’s realm of dominion and authority. In one sense, all of creation is God’s Kingdom.

Psalm 103:19 Instructor's Translation

The Lord has established **his throne in the skies**,
and **his kingdom** rules over all.

Psalm 145:10–13 NASB

All your works shall give thanks to you, O LORD, and your godly ones shall bless you.
They shall speak of **the glory of your kingdom** and talk of your power;
to make known to the sons of men your mighty acts and the glory of the majesty of **your kingdom**.
Your kingdom is an **everlasting kingdom**, and your dominion endures throughout all generations.

Daniel 4:2–3 NASB

It has seemed good to me to declare the signs and wonders which the Most High God has done for me.
How great are his signs and how mighty are his wonders! **His kingdom** is an **everlasting kingdom** and his dominion is from generation to generation.

Daniel 4:34 NASB

But at the end of that period, I, Nebuchadnezzar, raised my eyes toward heaven and my reason returned to me, and I blessed the Most High and praised and honored him who lives forever; for his dominion is an everlasting dominion, and **his kingdom endures from generation to generation**.

Note: “Kingdom of God/Heaven” does not mean “going to heaven.” It is just the opposite, an announcement that God’s space is coming into contact with our space.

References to God’s “Kingdom” and “will” suggest the idea, “What would it look like if God was running this show?” These ideas evoke the world as the creator intended it to be, and wants it to be again: a place of *shalom*, justice, abundance, community, etc.

The biblical authors use the term “new/renewed creation” to speak of this future hope ([Rom. 8:18-23](#); [21-22](#)), and of how this future hope has begun to infiltrate the present ([2 Cor. 5:17](#)).

The idea of God’s heavenly reign becoming realized on earth is what [Daniel 7](#) is all about.

Daniel 7:13–14 Instructor's Translation

I kept looking in the night visions,
and behold, with the clouds of heaven

one like a Son of Man was coming,
and he came up to the Ancient of Days
and was presented before him.
And **to him was given dominion** (שָׁלַטָּה),
glory and **a kingdom** (מְלָכּוּת),
that all the peoples, nations, and men of every language
might serve him.
His dominion is an everlasting dominion
which will not pass away;
and **his Kingdom** is one
which will not be destroyed.

Daniel 7:18 Instructor's Translation

But the saints of the Highest One will receive **the Kingdom**
and possess **the Kingdom** forever,
for all ages to come.

Daniel 7:27 NASB*

Then the sovereignty, the dominion and the greatness of all the kingdoms under the whole heaven will be given to the people of the saints of the Highest One; **his kingdom will be an everlasting kingdom, and all the dominions** will serve and obey Him.

Key Words Adapted by Teacher

In the Gospel of Matthew, the story begins with a conflict of kingdoms, as the first three uses of the word make clear.

Matthew 3:1-2 Instructor's Translation

Now in those days John the Baptist came, preaching in the wilderness of Judea, saying,
"Repent, for **the kingdom of the skies** has come near."

Matthew 4:8-9 Instructor's Translation

Again, the slanderer took him to a very high mountain and showed him all **the kingdoms of the world** and their glory; and he said to him, "All these things I will give you, if you fall down and worship me."

Matthew 4:17 Instructor's Translation

From that time Jesus began to preach and say, "Repent, for **the kingdom of the skies** is at hand."

The word "kingdom" (Greek: *basilea*) occurs 55 times in Matthew's account of Jesus' teaching and is used in a variety of ways. Jesus presents the Kingdom of God as both present in and through himself, but also as a future reality.

Sayings in which Jesus presents the Kingdom of Heaven as present reality for himself and his listeners:

Matthew 4:17 Instructor's Translation

From that time Jesus began to preach and say, "Repent, for the kingdom of the skies **has come near.**"

Matthew 10:6–7 NASB*

but rather go to the lost sheep of the house of Israel.
And as you go, preach, saying, “The kingdom of the skies **has come near.**”

Key Words Adapted by Teacher

Matthew 12:28 NASB

But if I cast out demons by the Spirit of God, then the kingdom of God **has come upon you.**

Matthew 18:3–4 NASB*

Truly I say to you, unless you are converted and become like children, **you will not enter** the kingdom of the skies. Whoever then humbles himself as this child, he is the greatest in the kingdom of the skies.

Key Words Adapted by Teacher

Matthew 19:23–24 NASB*

And Jesus said to his disciples, “Truly I say to you, it is hard for a rich man **to enter** the kingdom of the skies. Again I say to you, it is easier for a camel to go through the eye of a needle, than for a rich man **to enter** the kingdom of God.”

Key Words Adapted by Teacher

Matthew 21:31 NIV

“Which of the two did what his father wanted?” “The first,” they answered. Jesus said to them, “Truly I tell you, the tax collectors and the prostitutes **are entering** the kingdom of God ahead of you.”

Sayings in which Jesus presents the Kingdom as a future reality:

Matthew 8:11 Instructor's Translation

I say to you that **many will come** from east and west, and **will recline** at the table with Abraham, Isaac and Jacob in the kingdom of the skies;

Matthew 13:43 NASB

Then the righteous **will shine** forth as the sun in the kingdom of their Father. He who has ears, let him hear.

Matthew 16:28 NASB

Truly I say to you, there are some of those who are standing here who will not taste death **until they see the Son of Man coming in his kingdom.**

Matthew 26:27–29 NASB

And when he had taken a cup and given thanks, he gave it to them, saying, “Drink from it, all of you; for this is my blood of the covenant, which is poured out for many for forgiveness of sins.
But I say to you, **I will not drink of this fruit of the vine from now on until that day when I drink it new with you in my Father’s kingdom.**”

Good News for Israel

Matthew has carefully shaped the descriptions of who came to hear Jesus and where those people came from. If we compare Matthew’s version with his source in Mark, a number of important clues emerge as to the identity of the people coming to hear Jesus.

Matthew 4:23-25	Mark 1:14, 1:28, and 3:7-8
23 And he traveled around in all of Galilaia, teaching in their synagogues, and announcing the good news of the Kingdom, and healing every sickness and every disease among the people, 24 and the report about him went out into all of Syria. And they brought to him all who had illness with any variety of sicknesses, and those suffering tormenting-pain, and the demonized, and those suffering lunacy, and the paralyzed, and he healed them. 25 And many crowds followed him, from Galilaia, and the Dekapolis, and Ierosoluma, and Ioudaia, and beyond the Iordanes,	14 ... Jesus went into Galilee, announcing the good news of God ... 28 Immediately the report about him spread everywhere into all the surrounding district of Galilee. 7 Jesus withdrew to the sea with his disciples, and a great multitude followed; from Galilee and also from Judea, 8 and from Jerusalem, and from Idumea, and beyond the Jordan, and the vicinity of Tyre and Sidon ...
<i>Good News for Israel in Matthew and Mark. Created by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: The Messianic Torah (2024).</i>	

Matthew omitted the mention of Idumea and Tyre and Sidon, and he has added the Dekapolis. By these changes, Matthew has focused the stage of Jesus’ activity on precisely the settlement area of the 12 tribes (see [Joshua 13-19](#)), that is “from Dan to Beersheba” (see, for example, [Judges 20:1](#) or [1 Samuel 3:20](#)).

“The region of Decapolis added by Matthew covers the northern area of the east Jordan tribes (Reuben, Gad, and the half tribe of Manasseh; see [Numbers 32](#) and [Deuteronomy 3:12-20](#)). Tyre and Sidon, as well as Idumea (i.e., Edom) are deleted as Gentile territories. [Matthew portrays] the large crowds from all Israel responding to the appearance of Jesus. In [verse 24](#), it is the report about Jesus, not Jesus himself, that goes into all of Syria. ... These changes by Matthew about the crowds’ geographical origin ... can be seen as his sketch of the ‘land of Israel’ ([Matt. 2:20-21](#)).”

Konradt, Matthias (2020). [The Gospel according to Matthew: A Commentary](#). Baylor University Press. 62.



Logos contributors (2025). Map of the Middle East.

Calling All Apprentices

Matthew highlights how Jesus summoned four of his first disciples (Greek: *mathetes* / μαθητής) in two short and stylized narratives that are clearly modeled after one another.

- Both involve calling sibling sets: Simon Peter & Andrew and James & John.
- All four were fishermen, which provides Jesus’ main metaphor for calling them to participate in this mission. They are going to “fish for people,” a creative image for the missionary endeavor he has in mind for them. This theme will be developed later in [9:36-11:1](#) and [28:16-20](#).
- This twin pattern of calling and following creates a model of discipleship that will be repeated in the same words later in the calling of Matthew in [9:9](#).

Simon Peter & Andrew	James & John	Matthew
Matthew 4:18-20 ... he saw two brothers, Simon, who is called Petros, and Andreas his brother, throwing a fishing net into the sea, because they were fishers. And he said to them, “Come after me, and I will make you fishers of humans.” And immediately, leaving the nets, they followed him.	Matthew 4:21-22 And having moved on from there, he saw two other brothers, Iakobos, the one of Zebedaios, and Ioannes his brother, in the boat with Zebedaios their father, they were repairing their nets, and he called to them. And immediately, after leaving the boat and their father, they followed him.	Matthew 9:9 And when Iesous moved on from there, he saw a man, sitting at a tax-collecting- station, called Matthaios, and he said to him, “Follow me.” And getting up, he followed him.
<i>Calling All Apprentices. Created by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: The Messianic Torah (2024).</i>		

Matthew has clearly shaped these three scenes to mirror one another. It is likely that Matthew wants us to see something normative for his audience as well: If one is an apprentice of Jesus, when he calls, we are to follow. The motif is repeated in Matthew’s own call narrative in [9:9](#).

Matthew’s Compositional Strategy in Matthew 4:23-25

Matthew has drawn together the summary of Jesus’ daily ministry from multiple texts in his main source, the Gospel according to Mark. Below is a table that illustrates Matthew’s compositional method at work.

Matthew 4:23 And he traveled around in all of Galilaia, teaching in their synagogues, and announcing the good news of the kingdom, and healing every sickness and every disease among the people.	Mark 1:39 And he went into all Galilee announcing in their synagogues and casting out demons.
	Mark 6:6 ... and he was going around among the villages teaching.
Matthew 4:24 And the report about him went out into all of Syria, and they brought to him all who had illness with any variety of sicknesses, and those suffering tormenting-pain, and the demonized, and those suffering lunacy, and the paralyzed, and he healed them.	Mark 1:28 Immediately the report about him spread everywhere into all the surrounding district of Galilee.
	Mark 1:32-34 ³² ... they began bringing to him all who were ill and those who were demonized ... ³⁴ And he healed many who were ill with various diseases, and cast out many demons ...
Matthew 4:25 And many crowds followed him, from Galilaia, and the Dekapolis, and Ierosoluma, and Ioudaia, and beyond the Iordanes.	Mark 3:7-8 Jesus withdrew to the sea with his disciples, and a great multitude from Galilee followed; and also from Judea, and from Jerusalem, and from Idumea, and beyond the Jordan, and the vicinity of Tyre and Sidon, a great number of people heard of all that he was doing and came to him.
Matthew’s Compositional Strategy in 4:23-25. Created by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: The Messianic Torah (2024).	

Scriptural Background to the Kingdom of God

Statements of Yahweh as Israel's king

- Exodus 15:18 The conclusion to the Song of the Sea: This is significant because the first statement of "Yahweh as king" is over his newly redeemed people. God's kingship is demonstrated when slaves are freed and evil is confronted.
- Numbers 23:21 This is Balaam's oracle.
- Deuteronomy 33:5 A poetic recollection of King Yahweh coming to his people from Sinai.
- Judges 8:23 Gideon's refusal to rule because Yahweh rules over Israel.
- 1 Samuel 12:12 Yahweh is king of Israel, therefore their demand for a king is full of mixed motives.

Prophetic developments

- Isaiah:
 - He sees king Yahweh in the temple (Isa. 6:5).
 - He depicts Yahweh as king and ruler of Israel (33:22).
 - In Isaiah 40-55, Yahweh is king and redeemer (41:21; 44:6).
 - The announcement of good news is directly connected to Yahweh as king (52:7).
 - The apocalypse of Isaiah in 24:21-23 has a scene where Yahweh defeats rebellious kings on earth and the hosts of heaven by throwing them all in a pit, and Yahweh becomes king in Jerusalem.
 - This is key: In Isaiah, the good news is that God is present (40:9) and that God is king (52:7).
- Jeremiah depicts Yahweh as the one and only king (Jer. 10:6-7, 10) in contrast to idols.
- Zechariah describes a vision of Yahweh as universal king (Zech. 14:9, 16).

Yahweh's kingship in the Psalms

- Fully complete depiction of Yahweh as king: He sits on a throne (29:10, 47:8); he wears royal garb and robes (93:1); his throne is over the ark in the temple (99:1); as king he brings justice to the poor (74:12, 96:10); Zion is his capital city with its temple (48:2).

Yahweh's rule is connected with "good news"

- Isaiah 40:3 and then 52:7 are key here. Yahweh is coming to rescue, save, and become king. This is good news.
- Daniel's depiction of God's Kingdom elevates it to a cosmic level:
 - The struggle of God's Kingdom against evil is linked to the struggle of Israel's kingdom against its oppressors (Isa. 10:13-14).
 - This is linked to the tradition that begins in Deuteronomy 32:8-9 where Yahweh rules Israel, but other nations have other gods ruling them; Daniel 10:13-14 links the prince of Persia with evil spiritual forces.
 - This is key: In Daniel and Isaiah 24, we have the only two places where the conflict of God's Kingdom is with forces of evil behind human kingdoms. These themes are significantly developed in other Second Temple literature: Jubilees, 1 Enoch, and The Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs
 - There is an eschatological, temporal element of the Kingdom in Daniel: Human kingdoms controlled by spiritual evil will come in succession until they are all destroyed by God's Kingdom (2:44). The Kingdom will be given to the Son of Man as Daniel saw it given to holy ones of the Most High (7:18, 22, 27). Daniel must seal up the scroll and wait for the Kingdom to come (12:1-4).

“In Scripture God is understood as king, as ruling over a kingdom, which is understood as both the place and the event of his presence, his sphere of glory and power. The rule of God is regarded as the content of ‘good news’, and it is a rule that is anticipated soon, as the grand finale of all human kingdoms. It is also a rule that has and will encounter deadly opposition from Satan. For God’s rule to triumph, Satan’s rule will have to be shattered.”

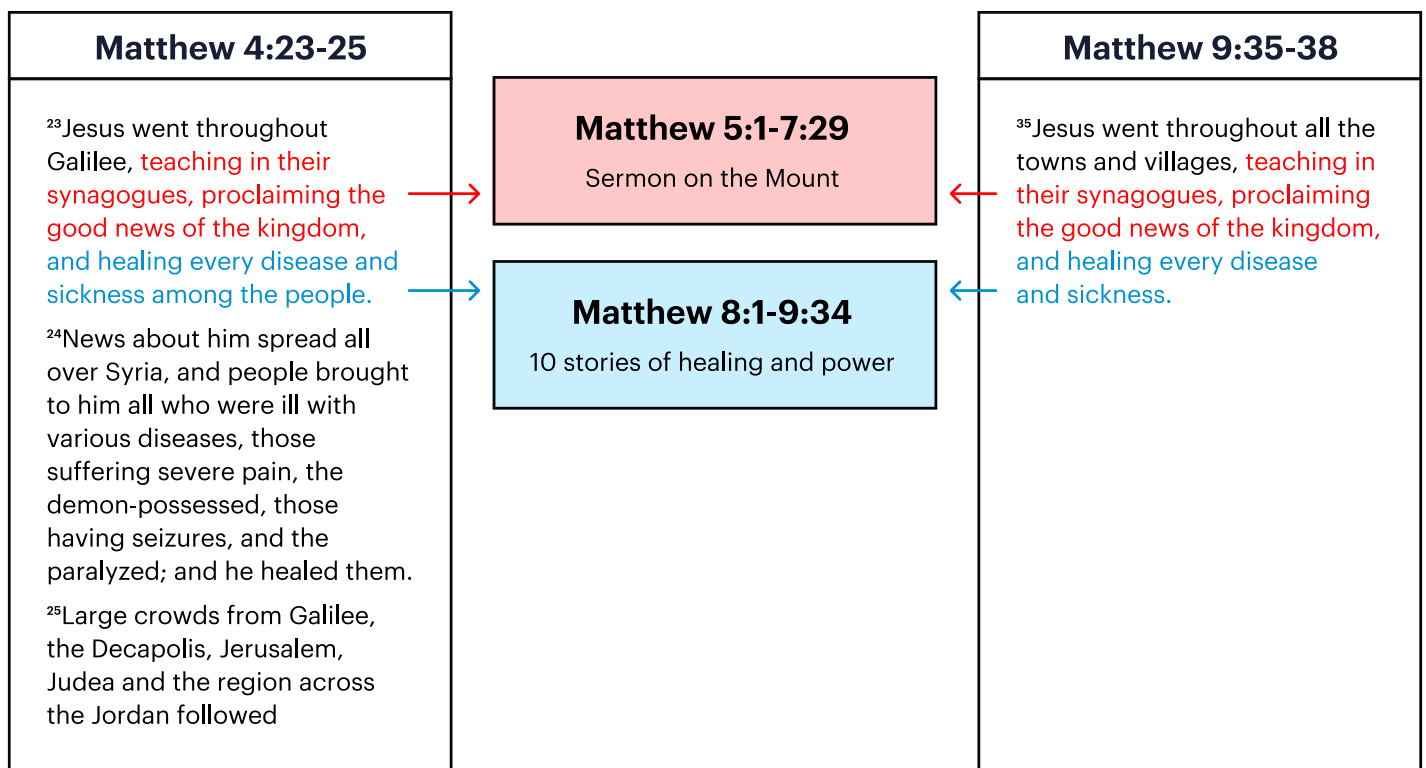
Evans, Craig (2005). “Inaugurating the Kingdom of God” in *Bulletin for Biblical Research* vol. 15.1. 49-75.

Jesus’ announcement of the Kingdom

- Mark 1:14-15 (see also Matt. 4:17): The Kingdom has come near. The language is drawn from Daniel 7:22 after the Most High decides in favor of the holy ones: “The time came and the holy ones possessed the Kingdom.” (Dan. LXX Theodotian uses ο καιρος εφθασεν και την βασιλειαν κατεσχον οι αγιοι).

Jesus’ inauguration of the Kingdom has a focus on combatting spiritual evil.

- The temptation of Jesus
- Jesus’ exorcisms
- Sending the 12
- Jesus’ healings



Jesus’ Teachings and Healings. Created by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: The Messianic Torah (2024).

Reflection Question

How does Matthew's organizational structure contribute to the overall message of his gospel?